1 Start with your own data

A practical guide to your first setup and first transaction. Prepared 9 October 2026. English interface, AED currency, Dubai reporting dates.

> **Your workspace is empty.** Fictional transactions, staff, customers, stock and campaigns have been cleared. Your owner login, two branch records and category setup remain. An encrypted demo archive is retained locally.

Open and sign in

1. Open http://127.0.0.1:3001/ on the Mac running Protune. This address is local; it is not an online hosting address.

2. Sign in using your existing owner email and password. The owner email is **owner@protune.local**. The password is intentionally omitted from this shareable guide.

3. Use the left navigation menu. On a phone, open the menu using the top-left menu button. Choose the branch and reporting date at the top when checking results.

Prepare these details before typing

Company name and TRN; branch names/codes; service names, prices excluding VAT and direct costs; employee names, emails, roles and branches; expense amounts and start dates. Add customer and stock details later if you need those modules.

Choose a testing rule

For practice, prefix names with **TEST** and use made-up contacts you control. Every saved test sale and expense affects the reports. Keep a separate testing workspace before entering live operations; there is no general undo or bulk-clear button.

Suggested order: Settings > Branches > Services > Employees > Sales > Expenses > Reports. Add CRM, inventory and job cards after the basic sale works.

2 Company, branches & services

Review company settings

1. Open **Settings**. Enter Company name and Tax registration number if applicable. Review VAT rate (%) and click **Save settings**. The current workspace starts with 5%; confirm your business setting before recording actual invoices.

2. VAT changes apply to new sales only. Previously saved invoices keep their historical values. Currency is AED and reporting uses Asia/Dubai.

3. Open **Branches**. Review Dubai Silicon Oasis (DSO) and Dubai Investments Park (DIP). Edit the names/codes or add your actual branches as needed. Keep the branches you use active.

Enter your first service

1. Open **Services** and use the add button. Enter Service name, Category, Estimated duration (minutes), Required team size and Material requirements. Keep it active.

2. For each branch where you offer the service, enter **Selling price (AED, excluding VAT)** and its cost components. Review every branch price before saving.

3. Choose the cost calculation: **Fixed AED**, **% of price**, or **Quantity x unit cost**. Percentage costs use the selling price before discount.

4. Use **DIRECT** for incremental service costs. Use **PAYROLL** for salaried labor so the system excludes it from direct cost. Record salary expense separately. Save the service.

> **Avoid double counting.** A cost already included in a service component should not also be entered as an operating expense. Material requirements text describes the service; tracked stock consumption needs an inventory recipe.

If a category is missing, use **Add category** in Services. Existing invoices retain their original service names, prices and costs when you edit the catalog.

3 Employees & access

Create an employee account

1. Open **Employees** and use the add button. Enter Full name, Email and a Unique password of at least 12 characters.

2. Choose Access role, enter Job title, Monthly salary (AED) and Working schedule. Select the employee's Branch assignments and keep the account active.

3. Save, then check the person appears under the correct branch. Use an individual email/password for each person.

4. Sign out and test the new account in a separate browser session. Confirm it sees only the intended branch and screens, then return to the owner account.

Role	What to expect
OWNER	Company-wide administration, prices, accounts, settings and finances.
MANAGER	Financial and operating access for assigned branches; company-wide owner controls remain restricted.
CASHIER	Assigned-branch checkout and payments. Service costs and financial profitability are hidden; manual discounts require manager/owner.
TECHNICIAN	Assigned work and attendance. Customer contacts, prices and financial screens are restricted.

Salary entry is not payroll posting

The employee's salary is a reference value. It does not automatically add a monthly operating expense or make a payment. Record payroll once in **Expenses**, using the relevant branch and recurring period. Mark salaried labor cost components PAYROLL to avoid duplication.

Change or remove access

Edit the employee to change branch assignments or reset the password. Leave New password blank to retain it. Deactivate an account that should no longer log in. Account/password changes revoke existing sessions; the user must sign in again.

4 Record your first sale

A sale represents a completed service. For work still in progress, use a job card instead of recording the sale early.

1. Open **Sales** and use the new-sale/checkout button. Choose the correct branch.

2. Enter Vehicle plate and Customer / walk-in. A registered customer is optional; walk-in checkout works with CRM disabled.

3. Select the completed Services and the Employees working on this vehicle. If your service is missing, check that it is active and configured for this branch.

4. Leave Discount at zero for your first test. Owners/managers may enter a manual AED discount. A voucher discount cannot be combined with a manual discount.

5. Review Total including VAT. Enter **Amount collected now** and choose CASH, CARD, TRANSFER or OTHER. Enter zero if the customer has not paid; the balance remains outstanding.

6. Save once, wait for confirmation, and find the invoice in the transaction ledger. Open its receipt and review the branch, plate, services, VAT and payment balance.

Practice example - only if you choose to enter it

Entry / result	Illustrative value
Service price excluding VAT	AED 50.00
Direct service cost	AED 15.00
Discount / VAT rate	AED 0.00 / 5%
Net revenue / VAT / invoice total	AED 50.00 / AED 2.50 / AED 52.50
Collected / outstanding if paid in full	AED 52.50 / AED 0.00
Contribution before operating expenses	AED 35.00

These figures are an example, not your business data. They have not been entered into the system. Revenue excludes VAT; customer balance includes VAT.

Collect the rest later

Use the invoice's payment action in Sales, enter the amount actually collected and its payment method, then save. Do not create another sale to collect an existing invoice. Unpaid cancellation is restricted; paid invoices cannot be refunded through cancellation. Stock-consuming or completed-job invoices have additional cancellation restrictions.

5 Expenses & daily checks

Enter an expense

1. Open **Expenses** and click **Record expense**. Select Branch and Category; add a clear Description.

2. Enter Amount (AED) and Expense date / recurrence starts. Choose Allocation: **One-time**, **Recurring monthly**, or **Annual amount / 12 each month**.

3. Choose Expense type: fixed operating, other non-operating, manually recorded tax, or variable costs not included in service costs.

4. Review Revision effective from month and Active, then save. Edits preserve earlier versions by effective month; closed periods cannot be revised.

> **Choose the right amount.** Monthly allocation expects the monthly amount. Annual allocation expects the full annual amount. A one-time expense uses its recorded date. Recurring costs are allocated across calendar days, so a partial-month view may show only part of a monthly expense.

Separate profitability from cash

Expenses measure cost commitments and do not automatically record a bank/cash payment. Customer payments are recorded in Sales. For other actual cash movements, use the cash journal in **Investment & ROI**. Keep capital, deposits and operating expenses separate; entering an investment does not create sales revenue.

A five-minute daily review

1. Set the same branch and reporting dates you used for entry. In **Sales**, check invoice totals, collected amounts and balances.

2. In **Overview**, check VAT-exclusive revenue, direct service costs and operating expenses. Team assignments must not multiply invoice revenue.

3. In **Reports**, review the period and export if needed. Reconcile recorded collections against actual cash/card/bank receipts.

4. Review **Audit log** for changes. Resolve incorrect settings or entries before adding more transactions.

Operating profit uses net revenue less service costs and operating expenses. Net profit also deducts separately recorded other/tax expenses. Tax expenses are entered manually; salary profiles do not automatically post payroll.

6 Customers, stock & workshop

These are optional next steps. Test the basic sale first so prices, employee access and payments are clear.

Customers

1. Open **Customers** as owner and enable CRM if you want registered profiles. Create a customer for the appropriate branch and add their vehicle.

2. At checkout, select that customer and vehicle so the sale links to their history. Existing invoices retain their original snapshots.

3. New customers begin opted out of marketing. Record genuine channel consent and evidence before enabling delivery. Changing contact information revokes consent for that channel.

Inventory

1. Open **Inventory**. Define an item, then receive its quantity and cost into the correct branch. Set its reorder level and storage location.

2. Configure a service material recipe if checkout should consume stock. It replaces the relevant estimated cost component with actual weighted stock cost.

3. Verify receipt quantity, weighted unit cost and remaining balance. Stock receipts are not automatic cash/expense postings. Do not count the same material cost twice.

Job cards

1. Open **Job cards**. Create the customer/vehicle job and assign employees. Inspect it and prepare a quotation with services, labor and parts.

2. Record actual customer approval and evidence. Every quotation revision needs new approval before work continues.

3. Assigned technicians start approved work and record time. Stop timers before completion. Completion consumes quoted stock once and freezes actual material costs.

4. Generate its invoice once and collect payments in Sales. Mark delivered when appropriate; delivery does not silently pay the balance.

> **Keep live delivery off while testing.** Marketing needs SMTP/WhatsApp provider configuration, templates and consent before real messages can be sent. Start with customer records and manual workflow checks.

Refunds, stock returns and attendance correction are not currently available. Avoid using real paid invoices to practise reversal workflows.

7 Your first-session checklist

Before the first transaction

[ ] Company name, TRN and VAT setting reviewed.

[ ] Branch names/codes and active status reviewed.

[ ] One service created with a price and costs for the chosen branch.

[ ] One employee created with the correct role and branch assignment.

[ ] Practice records clearly labeled TEST; live messaging stays off.

After the first transaction

[ ] Invoice lists the correct plate, customer, branch and service.

[ ] Net revenue, VAT and invoice total agree with your calculation.

[ ] Amount collected and outstanding balance agree with the payment.

[ ] Direct cost and contribution are correct; payroll is not duplicated.

[ ] Receipt and report are readable; employee access is appropriate.

If something is missing

Problem	First check
No services at checkout	Active service, active branch and that branch's service price.
Employee not selectable	Active employee and assignment to the selected branch.
Reports look empty	Selected branch/date range, saved invoice and any cancellation.
Unexpected profit	VAT-exclusive revenue, cost sources, discount, expense period and duplicated costs.
Customer controls unavailable	Owner CRM switch and your role/branch permissions.
Website shows Nara	Use Protune at port 3001, not port 3000.

Before moving to live operations, use a separate production database, change evaluation credentials, configure HTTPS and backups, and verify the hosted workflow. Local testing does not activate public hosting.